



M/J Latin, Intermediate

COURSE 0706010 • GRADES 7–8 • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: A year-long middle-school Latin course that builds real reading and translation ability. Semester 1 lays the foundation — pronunciation, the five noun cases and first two declensions, then verbs: conjugating, parsing, and the present and imperfect tenses. Semester 2 extends the grammar (future tense, irregular verbs, adjectives) and pivots toward applied work: a multi-week **Julius Caesar research paper**, Roman history and culture readings, and translating connected Latin stories set in ancient Pompeii — closing with a comprehensive portfolio of the year's work.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE (weekly modules, grouped)

Aug–Sep	Welcome, alphabet & pronunciation; the noun system: five cases, 1st & 2nd declensions, vocabulary lists 1–3
Oct	Noun unit review • Noun Unit Exam • “Teach the Teacher about Nouns” • Roman culture: aqueducts, medicine
Oct–Dec	Verbs: attributes, stems, conjugating; imperfect & future tenses; the W.R.A.P. memorization method • Verb Quizzes 1 & 2
Jan	Semester review; parsing with purpose
Jan–Feb	Julius Caesar research paper : thesis → sources → outline → final paper • irregular verbs & <i>sum</i> , 2nd conjugation
Mar–Apr	Reading real Latin: the Caecilius stories of Pompeii (Roman names, the banker's strongbox, the Roman house)
Apr–May	Latin adjectives & vocabulary • Comprehensive Portfolio (year-end capstone)

PROJECTS

- **Julius Caesar research paper** — a guided, multi-week paper built in stages (thesis, sources, outline, final draft).
- **Teach the Teacher about Nouns** — students flip roles and teach the noun system.
- **Comprehensive Portfolio** — the year-end collection showing everything mastered.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **Grammar/vocabulary notes page** — the week's new concept
- **1–2 practice assignments** tied to that grammar (case practice, conjugation, translation)
- **Vocabulary review** on Quizlet (Sem 1) or Blooket (Sem 2)
- **Duolingo practice** — a standing assignment nearly every week, all year
- **Quiz or test** at unit boundaries (every few weeks)

TIME COMMITMENT

≈4 hours per week (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Notes & new grammar ≈1 hr • practice & translation ≈1½ hr • Duolingo/Quizlet/Blooket ≈1 hr • review & assessments ≈½ hr

Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Research-paper weeks may run longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas
- Free accounts on **Duolingo**, **Quizlet**, and **Blooket** (set up in week 1)
- VR headset for occasional VR activities (live-school students use VR daily)

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.